



ORGANISATION INTERNATIONALE
DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

BUREAU INTERNATIONAL DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE
OF LEGAL METROLOGY

TWENTY - THIRD MEETING
Sydney - 24th and 28th October 1988

MINUTES

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TWENTY-THIRD MEETING
of the
INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE of LEGAL METROLOGY

Sydney - 24 and 28 October 1988

The International Committee of Legal Metrology was convened by its President, Mr K. BIRKELAND, and met in Sydney, on the occasion of the Eighth International Conference of Legal Metrology.

It held two sessions, Monday morning 24th October and Friday late morning 28th October.

LIST OF PERSONS ATTENDING

The following persons were present :

Federal Republic of Germany	: M. KOCHSIEK E. SEILER C. VOLKMANN	Member, CIML
German Democratic Republic	: K. HASCHÉ	Member, CIML
Australia	: J. BIRCH	Member, CIML
Austria	: R. LEWISCH	Member, CIML
Canada	: R.G. KNAPP	Member, CIML
People's Republic of China	: SONG YONGLIN WANG XIAOWEI	Member, CIML
Republic of Korea	: B.G. SON C.H. RHEE S.Y. LEE	Member, CIML
Cuba	: A. OJEDA SENRA	
Denmark	: O.E. PETERSEN	Member, CIML
Spain	: M. CADARSO	Member, CIML
United States of America	: S.E. CHAPPELL S. WARSHAW A. THOLEN	V/President, CIML
Finland	: U. LÄHTEENMÄKI (Mrs)	Member, CIML
France	: P. BERTRAN A. LE BOUCH	Member, CIML
Greece	: J. KAPONIKOLOS T. VLACHOS	
Hungary	: D. BELEDI P. PAKAY	Member, CIML
India	: B. SINHA	
Indonesia	: G. PUTERA	Member, CIML
Ireland	: J. LOWE	Member, CIML
Italy	: C. AMODEO F. BONI	Member, CIML
Japan	: S. HATTORI K. SETA	Member, CIML
Kenya	: P. AYATA	Member, CIML
Norway	: K. BIRKELAND	President, CIML
Netherlands	: G.J. FABER	Member, CIML
Poland	: T. PODGORSKI Z. PESTRAKIEWICZ	Member, CIML
Portugal	: H. MACHADO-JORGE	

United Kingdom	:	P.B. CLAPHAM	Member, CIML
Sri Lanka	:	H. MADANAYAKE	Member, CIML
Sweden	:	R. OHLON	Member, CIML
Switzerland	:	P. KOCH	Member, CIML
Tanzania	:	A.H.M. TUKAI	Member, CIML
Czechoslovakia	:	M. CIBAK	Member, CIML
U.S.S.R.	:	A.I. MEKHANNIKOV A.S. VISHENKOV M. ZYKIN	V/President, CIML
Honorary Member of the Committee	:	A.J. VAN MALE	Past-President

International Bureau of Legal Metrology :

B. ATHANÉ, S.A. THULIN.

Delegations of votes :

Mrs HENRION (Belgium) to Mr FABER (Netherlands),
Mr ZLATAREV (Bulgaria) to Mr MEKHANNIKOV (USSR),
Mr BENKIRANE (Morocco) to Mr BERTRAN (France),
Mr VEGLIA (Monaco) to Mr BERTRAN (France),
Mr MEZEK (Yugoslavia) to Mr BIRKELAND (Norway).

Apologies :

Brazil, Cameroon, Cyprus, Pop. Dem. Rep. of Korea, Egypt, Ethiopia, Israel,
Pakistan, Rumania, Tunisia.

Countries which had not nominated a Committee Member :

Algeria, Guinea, Lebanon.

OPENING ADDRESS

by K. BIRKELAND, President of the Committee

Ladies, Gentlemen, my dear Colleagues,

It gives me great pleasure to find so many of you here at this gathering which we decided upon four years ago, following the Australian government's invitation to the Conference and to the Committee to meet in Sydney.

For many of you it has been a long journey, with a change of the clock and even a complete change of season. We must not forget that these are the kinds of annoyances which the Australian delegations and those of the other countries of the southern hemisphere encounter every year, or even several times a year, when they take part in meetings of OIML or other international institutions which have their headquarters of their working groups in the northern hemisphere, particularly in Europe.

In fact in this month of October 1988 a large number of metrologists and specialists in testing or in the accreditation of laboratories, from all horizons, are to be found in Oceania. Last week the International Laboratory Accreditation Conference was held in New Zealand, and many of us, including me, took part. Next week will be the jubilee of the National Measurement Laboratory, which will attract many scientists, many of whom are already here among us.

But today it is Sydney, or rather this charming seaside suburb of Manly, which becomes the centre of the legal metrological world, and I would like at this point to tell our Australian colleague, Mister BIRCH, how much we appreciate all the time and effort he has devoted to the preparations for our meetings. We shall certainly have the opportunity to express our thanks to our hosts later on; I would like, without further ado, to broach with you the various subjects that we are going to deal with during this twenty third meeting of the Committee.

I shall be brief. This afternoon I shall present a progress report to the Conference covering these last four years; so I shall raise now only those matters which concern the Committee proper.

First of all, according to tradition, I would like to welcome the new Members of the Committee.

For Egypt, Mr HILAL replaces Mr SALEM.

For the United States of America, Mr CHAPPELL has replaced Mr EDGERLY; both were present at our last meeting, but this is the first time that Mr CHAPPELL has attended our Committee as a Member.

Finally, for the USSR, Mr MEKHANNIKOV has been nominated to replace Mr ISSAEV.

To all three I offer my best wishes and bid them welcome, and I thank them in advance for the work that they will do for OIML.

But our Committee has not only been affected by the nominations of new Members. One of us has, alas! very suddenly and tragically died. Jorge GOMEZ ROSSELL, Director of the Cuban National Metrological Institute, took an active part in our work for many years.

He had presided over the Development Council for two successive terms, each of two years, a mark of the esteem and confidence in which he was held by his colleagues of the Committee. The recent meetings of the Development Council and of the Pilot Secretariat SP 31 on training in metrology, and the staging of a seminar, were a splendid close to his four years of presidency. Some three months later a cardiac crisis bore him from us.

I ask you to observe a few moments of silence in his memory.

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Thank you.

Let us now turn to the future.

This morning, during the first session of the Committee, we shall discuss a number of matters to do with the Conference, its agenda and some of the items thereon. We shall, of course, content ourselves with a rapid glance at most of these topics, because they will be discussed in detail at the level of the Conference. Nevertheless some extremely important subjects such as certification and its related topics, or again work planning, will be brought up.

We shall also have to deal with other topics proper to the Committee, either this morning or Friday afternoon.

To conclude, the Committee will have the important task of designating its two Vice-presidents, for the previous two title holders, Mr ISSAEV and Dr EDGERLY have both laid down their responsibilities within this assembly, having been called to other duties in their respective countries.

There, ladies, gentlemen, my dear colleagues, is the work programme which I propose for you. No doubt Mr BIRCH has a few words that he wishes to say to us. Then I shall ask the Director of the Bureau to give us whatever information is necessary, after which we can begin our discussions.

Thank you.

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M. BIRCH welcomed the Members of CIML and all others attending and expressed his pleasure and that of his colleagues at NSC in organizing the meetings. It was his wish that all the delegates would enjoy their stay in Sydney and its surroundings. A social programme and visits had been organized for all the delegates and accompanying persons and Mr BIRCH hoped that all the presents would find these arrangements satisfactory.

Mr BIRCH indicated also that numerous Australian observers, members of NSC or of other bodies, would attend the OIML meeting and that this would be an opportunity for establishing useful contacts with delegates from other countries. Owing to Australia's geographical situation, a large part of that country's participation in OIML work was by correspondence; this week was therefore a unique opportunity for multiple personal contacts.

Mr BIRCH concluded by thanking all the delegates present and wishing them an agreeable stay.

On behalf of all the CIML Members, Mr BIRKELAND thanked Mr BIRCH for his invitation to meet in a such a pleasant country; he expressed the hope that the touristic attractions of the district of Sydney would not prevent the delegates from attending the working sessions!

Mr BIRKELAND expressed also his great pleasure in being able to welcome Mr A.J. VAN MALE, Past President of the Committee, who was warmly applauded.

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Roll-call of Delegates — Quorum

After the opening speeches, the roll of delegates was called; it was established that 37 Members of the Committee were present or represented out a total of 47. The statutory quorum of three-quarters was thus attained.

Adoption of the agenda

The Committee adopted the following agenda :

1. Minutes of the 22nd meeting of the Committee and reconsideration of the minutes of the 21st meeting
2. Auditor's report for 1987 and other financial matters
3. Eighth Conference : organization of the sessions, presidency, agenda
4. Work programmes for 1989-1992 and priority criteria
5. Certification
6. The situation of certain Secretariats
7. Report on the activities of BIML
8. Vice-Presidency of the Committee
9. Implementation of the decisions of the Eighth Conference
10. Any other business
11. Date and place of the next meeting

MINUTES

1. MINUTES OF THE 22nd MEETING OF THE COMMITTEE AND RECONSIDERATION OF THE MINUTES OF THE 21ST MEETING

The minutes of the 22nd meeting of the Committee were approved without modification.

As regards the minutes of the 21st meeting, the Committee decided to amend the Resolution CIML 1986 — Item 13.1.b, last paragraph, as follows :

URGES the CIML Members to facilitate the exchange of such information, which in principle may only be provided with the agreement of the manufacturer (or its representative, importer, etc.) of the instrument concerned.

2. AUDITOR'S REPORT FOR 1987 AND OTHER FINANCIAL MATTERS

a. The Committee approved the Auditor's report for 1987 and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit it to the Eighth Conference.

b. The Committee took note of information on the OIML working capital, presented by the Director of the Bureau. This working capital shall make it possible to pay the expenses of the beginning of the year, avoiding the necessity to draw on the reserve fund. For many years the working capital on 1st January of each year amounted to 100 000 FRF and now this represented only a small part of the expenses in the early weeks of the year. The Committee accepted a proposal from the Director of the Bureau to increase this amount to 362 900 FRF (or exactly 200 000 gold-francs) by transfer from the reserve fund, so that this operation would result in no modification of the overall budget of the Organization or of the contributions of Member States.

Mr CLAPHAM remarked that the initial amount of the working capital was justified by the fact that too many Member States did not pay their contributions at the beginning of the year, as required by the Convention. This was due to the administrative and financial rules applied by these States. The Committee, however, should request its Members to contact their financial authorities so that the contributions might be paid as soon as possible.

Mr BIRKELAND expressed his full agreement with this suggestion and encouraged his colleagues in the Committee to act accordingly.

c. The Committee accepted a request from the Government of Indonesia to place that country in contributory class 1 as of 1st January 1989 owing to economic problems resulting from the fall in the prices of oil and natural gas. Mr PUTERA said that he would ask to be placed in contributory class 2 when the economic well being of his country was restored.

3. EIGHTH CONFERENCE : ORGANIZATION OF THE SESSIONS, PRESIDENCY, AGENDA

The Committee accepted proposals from its President relating to the organization of the Eighth Conference. It also agreed to nominate respectively Mr RICHARDS, Chairman of the National Standards Commission (Australia), and Mr LEWISH (Austria) and Mr PUTERA (Indonesia), for the Presidency and the vice-Presidencies of the Conference. These nominations were proposed by Mr BIRCH and Mr BIRKELAND respectively.

4. WORK PROGRAMMES FOR 1989-1992 AND PRIORITY CRITERIA

Mr BIRKELAND first made the remark that the draft work programmes were prepared by the Pilot Secretariats and Reporting Secretariats, and sent to the

Bureau for compilation and submission to the Committee for approval and to the Conference for information.

As there had been no comment, Mr BIRKELAND declared these work programmes to be approved by the Committee. He charged the Bureau with reminding the pilot secretariats and reporting secretariats that they should follow these programmes as closely as possible. He indicated that the Presidential Council would periodically examine the progress of the work and report to the Committee.

As regards priority criteria, Mr ATHANÉ pointed out that the Presidential Council has studied this matter before an initial proposal had been presented to the Members of the Committee in July 1988. A final proposal, taking account of comments made by some Members of the Committee, was submitted in September 1988.

According to the final proposal, the subjects of work to be considered as having priority for the period 1989-1992, would be the following :

- a) the specification of the metrological characteristics, and of the methods and equipment to be used in the testing, of measuring instruments used in :
 - trade (retail or wholesale, domestic or international) in commodities and services of real economic importance ;
 - health and safety and the protection of the environment.
- b) the general operation of national metrological services; to improve, rationalise and unify the general working methods used by national metrological services in metrological control.
- c) the development of international cooperation to establish a certification scheme applicable to measuring instruments which are the subjects of OIML Recommendations, particularly where there are known to be technical barriers to trade.

To the above criteria must be added two motivations which can reinforce a topic's priority :

- needs expressed by international or regional institutions ;
- needs specific to developing countries.

Note : the order of presentation of the subjects a), b) and c) above does not imply an order of precedence.

Mr ATHANÉ lastly reminded the Committee that it was not requested to give formal approval to these criteria, only to consider them as generally appropriate as a basis for setting up the work programmes for 1989-1992 and as a guide for the Secretariats and the Bureau for their work during the next three or four years ; it was well understood that these criteria could evolve according to circumstances.

Mr PETERSEN considered the final proposal to be acceptable, since it represented well the results of the numerous discussions and exchanges of information which had taken place on this subject in the past. He therefore supported the proposal and insisted on the value of this work.

Since no Member of the Committee was opposed, Mr BIRKELAND declared the priority criteria to have been accepted by the Committee as general guidelines for the OIML technical work for the coming years.

5. CERTIFICATION

a. Discussions prior to the meeting of the Conference

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee all the work which had already been done on this subject within OIML. He considered that it had now reached a point which was perhaps not final but which nevertheless made it possible to take

formal decisions. These decisions would have to be taken at two levels: first the Committee should agree that the "Report on Certification" be presented to the Conference for consideration. Then the Conference would perhaps take decisions that the Committee would have to implement in its turn.

Mr KOCH, although supporting the "Report", regretted that an "OIML mark" was not envisaged immediately. He felt that, for a country like Switzerland which is at a cross roads of international trade, such a mark would be extremely useful. He hoped that future work would quickly be directed towards the establishment of an "OIML mark".

Reacting to Mr KOCH's remarks, Mr CLAPHAM felt on the contrary that an OIML mark should not be an objective, at least in the immediate future. In fact, many national regulations would disallow the existence of marks other than the already accepted national or regional marks; moreover, the operation and the control of a mark system would be far more difficult than that for a certificates system. For example, how could OIML prevent a manufacturer applying a mark similar to OIML's, unscrupulously or because he considered his instruments conformed to OIML requirements?

In reply to questions from Mr FABER, Mr ATHANÉ said that the work load resulting from the registration of certificates of conformity could be assumed by the Bureau without any need for an increase in its staff, at least for the time being. In addition, certificates would have to be a standardized format, and other details questions would have to be settled: this would create some additional burdens for the Bureau, but not beyond acceptable limits.

Mr SINHA supported in principle the objective OIML was trying to attain. However, many questions would have to be answered before, to achieve a real harmonization of the national certification systems. It would be necessary to take account of the differences existing between industrialized and developing countries; limits would have to be fixed for the extent of certification (certification of patterns only or also of individual instruments); it would be also necessary to study carefully the question of registration of certificates. With so many difficulties to surmount, OIML should proceed cautiously.

Mr PUTERA told the Committee about the system of licences which were granted to local manufacturers or importers in Indonesia. He said that, if an OIML Certificate scheme was set up, Indonesia would examine it carefully to see to what extent it could be used in parallel with the present rules.

Mr SINHA remarked that the ultimate goal of certification was to facilitate trade in products of good quality. However, in the field of measuring instruments, the correct operation of such a scheme would come up against a lack of harmonization between national regulations. The primary objective would therefore be to ensure so that national regulations and processes for pattern approval and verification were based on OIML Recommendations. It would be essential, however, to realize that conditions differed from one country to another. For example, an instrument which was designed to operate correctly in a temperate climate could be inappropriate for a warm and humid country. OIML Certificates should take account of the climatic and environmental conditions which existed in the various countries and which could influence the operation of instruments. Therefore Mr SINHA once more suggested that OIML work in the field of certification should proceed with caution.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded the discussion by noting that the Committee agreed to submit the "Report on Certification" to the Conference. He said that, if the Conference adopted the draft Resolution, the Committee would have to reconsider the question immediately. The importance and the urgency of this matter should

not be forgotten. If OIML was unable to set up an international certification system for measuring instruments rapidly, other institutions would do so, to the prejudice of OIML and of the national metrology services.

b. Discussions which took place after the meeting of the Conference :

Mr BIRKELAND read out the Resolution adopted by the Conference :

The International Conference of Legal Metrology

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the report on possible OIML Certification Schemes presented by the International Committee of Legal Metrology,

CONSIDERING the possibility of establishing either an OIML Certificate Scheme or an OIML Mark Scheme,

CONSIDERING the difficulties to be overcome before a Mark Scheme can be established owing to possible operational difficulties, the need to create mutual confidence between Members of the Scheme, and the cost of its operation,

CONSIDERING on the contrary that an OIML Certificate Scheme could be put into operation more easily, at lower cost and without creating unacceptable obligations for the OIML Member States,

CONSIDERING the usefulness of having such a System available for use by the Member States as soon as possible,

INSTRUCTS the International Committee of Legal Metrology to draw up the detailed rules of operation of a voluntary OIML Certificate Scheme.

In application of this Resolution, the Committee adopted the following Resolution :

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

IN CONSIDERATION of Resolution C8-1988 Item 7 by which the Conference instructs it to draw up detailed working rules for a voluntary OIML Certificate Scheme so as to make the Scheme available for use by the Member States as soon as possible,

INSTRUCTS Reporting Secretariat SP 2-Sr 4, for which the BIML is responsible, to start work immediately to that effect,

REQUESTS that Secretariat to concentrate its endeavours on a Certificate Scheme applicable to patterns of measuring instruments,

CONSIDERS that the main features of the Scheme could be the following :

- a Scheme open to all Member States of OIML wishing to participate in it,*
- every Member of the Committee able, within the rules drawn up to that effect, to issue certificates attesting the conformity of a pattern of a measuring instruments to the requirements of the appropriate OIML Recommendation,*
- other Member States able to accept such certificates purely voluntarily,*
- maintenance by BIML of a register of certificates issued,*

INSTRUCTS the Presidential Council to oversee this work and to report on it at the next meeting of the Committee.

The adoption of this Resolution was preceded by question and comments from Mr BERTRAN, Mr CLAPHAM and Mr SINHA, with the purpose of clarifying certain points and amending the draft Résolution.

6. THE SITUATION OF CERTAIN SECRETARIATS

Mr ATHANÉ presented a number of proposals from Member States to disband existing Reporting Secretariats (because they had completed their work, or because their field of work had been subsumed into the work programme of another Secretariat, or because the subjects concerned were of low interest or were already completely dealt with by other international institutions), and to create new Secretariats.

In addition, the general situation of certain Secretariats was discussed during the session.

Following these discussions, the Committee took the following decisions :

- a — The Committee disbanded the following Reporting Secretariats :
 - SP 2-Sr 1 Basic laws and regulations
 - SP 9-Sr 5 Pycnometers
 - SP 13-Sr 4 Measurement transformers and electrical energy meters used with measurement transformers
 - SP 18-Sr 4 Automatic saccharimeters for sugar beet
 - SP 18-Sr 8 Milk butyrometers
 - SP 26-Sr 2 Pipettes for mixing blood
 - SP 26-Sr 3 Westergren pipettes
 - SP 27-Sr 2 Classification of reference materials
 - SP 27-Sr 7 Methods of comparison of reference materials
- b — The Committee allocated to Portugal responsibility for SP 5S.
- c — The Committee disbanded the Reporting Secretariat SP 17-Sr 3 " Measurement of Pollutants by Radionuclides " and set up the new Reporting Secretariat SP 16-Sr 3 for the same subject, and placed responsibility for this Secretariat with the United Kingdom.

In addition, the Committee took note of information given by the Representative of the United Kingdom, concerning the reexamination of the work programme of SP 16.
- d — The Committee took note of information given by the Representative of USSR concerning the reexamination of the work programme of SP 21.

7. REPORT ON THE ACTIVITIES OF BIML

The Committee took note of the report on the activities of BIML for the period September 1987 to October 1988.

8. VICE-PRESIDENCY OF THE COMMITTEE

The Committee unanimously elected for a six year period :

as First Vice-President : Dr A.I. MEKHANNIKOV (USSR)

as Second Vice-President : Dr S.E. CHAPPELL (USA).

9. IMPLEMENTATION OF THE DECISIONS OF THE EIGHTH CONFERENCE

In application of a decision by the Conference under item 5 of its agenda, the Committee charged the Bureau with transcribing the discussions under that item and sending the text as soon as possible to the Members of CIML, to be considered by the Presidential Council and then by the Committee.

As regards the implementation of the decisions of the Conference relating to certification, see item 5 above.

10. ANY OTHER BUSINESS

There was no other business.

11. DATE AND PLACE FOR THE NEXT MEETING

Mr BIRKELAND expressed the view that a meeting of the Committee was necessary within a year to progress certain urgent matters such as certification.

Mr ATHANÉ said that contacts were already established with the Bureau International des Poids et Mesures and the French Administration to consider how the creation of the metric system might be commemorated within the celebration of the bicentenary of the French Revolution. The Bureau also envisaged organizing a seminar for developing countries in September 1989 in Paris. It was therefore suggested that the Committee should meet in Paris, for three days in the week from 25 to 29 September 1989 (1).

M. BERTRAN confirmed that the French Administration had already started preparing various commemorative events linked with the bicentenary of the French Revolution and expressed the hope that the Committee would accept the Bureau's proposal.

Mr CHAPPELL requested that every effort be made to ensure that the draft Recommendations that the Committee was now authorized to approve on behalf of the Conference be distributed to CIML Members with sufficient time to allow all States to study them carefully before meeting.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded by inviting his Colleagues to meet in Paris in September 1989.

Mr MACHADO-JORGE informed the meeting that Portugal would be happy to act as host to a meeting of the Committee in 1990 or 1991, for example.

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CLOSURE

Mr BIRKELAND closed the 23rd meeting of the Committee by expressing to Mr BIRCH and his colleagues at NSC his full appreciation to the perfect manner in which the meeting had been organized and by thanking the Members of CIML for their active participation in the discussion.

(1) Now fixed for 27, 28 and 29 September.

RESOLUTIONS and DECISIONS

CIML 1988 — ITEM 1

- a — The Committee approved the minutes of its 22nd meeting.*
- b — The Committee modified the Resolution CIML 1986 — Item 13.1.b adopted by the Committee during its 21st meeting in April 1986 ; the last paragraph shall read as follows :*

URGES the CIML Members to facilitate the exchange of such information, which in principle may only be provided with the agreement of the manufacturer (or its representative, importer, etc.) of the instrument concerned.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 2

- a — The Committee approved the auditor's report for 1987 and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit it to the Eighth Conference.*
- b — The Committee decided to increase to 200 000 GF the working capital of the Organization, by a transfer from the reserve fund, so that this operation results in no modification of the overall budget of the Organization, or of the contributions of Member States.*
- c — The Committee accepted the request presented by the Government of Indonesia to place this country in contributory class 1 as of 1st January 1989.*

CIML 1988 — ITEM 3

The Committee accepted the proposals concerning the organization of the Eighth Conference : presidency, agenda, time table, etc.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 4

- a — Work programmes for 1989-1992*

The Committee adopted the work programmes for 1989-1992 submitted by the Pilot and Reporting Secretariats and by the Bureau. It instructed the Secretariats to follow these programmes as closely as possible and charged the Presidential Council with examining periodically the progress of the work and reporting to the Committee at each of its sessions.

- b — Priority criteria*

The Committee considered that the priority criteria submitted by the Bureau were appropriate as a basis for the setting up of the work programmes for 1989-1992.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 5

- a — The Committee decided to submit to the Conference the report on certification developed by the Presidential Council and the Bureau.*
- b — Following the examination of the report on certification by the Conference the Committee adopted the following Resolution :*

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

IN CONSIDERATION of Resolution C8-1988 Item 7 by which the Conference instructs it to draw up detailed working rules for a voluntary OIML Certificate Scheme so as to make the Scheme available for use by the Member States as soon as possible,

INSTRUCTS Reporting Secretariat SP 2-Sr 4, for which the BIML is responsible, to start work immediately to that effect,

REQUESTS that Secretariat to concentrate its endeavours on a Certificate Scheme applicable to patterns of measuring instruments,

CONSIDERS that the main features of the Scheme could be the following :

- a Scheme open to all Member States of OIML wishing to participate in it,*
- every Member of the Committee able, within the rules drawn up to that effect,*
- to issue certificates attesting the conformity of a pattern of a measuring instrument to the requirements of the appropriate OIML Recommendation,*
- other Member States able to accept such certificates purely voluntarily,*
- maintenance by BIML of a register of certificates issued,*

INSTRUCTS the Presidential Council to oversee this work and to report on it at the next meeting of the Committee.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 6

a — The Committee disbanded the following Reporting Secretariats :

SP 2-Sr 1 Basic laws and regulations

SP 9-Sr 5 Pycnometers

SP 13-Sr 4 Measurement transformers and electrical energy meters used with measurement transformers

SP 18-Sr 4 Automatic saccharimeters for sugar beet

SP 18-Sr 8 Milk butyrometers

SP 26-Sr 2 Pipettes for mixing blood

SP 26-Sr 3 Westergren pipettes

SP 27-Sr 2 Classification of reference materials

SP 27-Sr 7 Methods of comparison of reference materials

b — The Committee allocated to Portugal responsibility for SP 5S.

c — The Committee disbanded the Reporting Secretariat SP 17-Sr 3 "Measurement of Pollutants by Radionuclides" and set up the new Reporting Secretariat SP 16-Sr 3 for the same subject, and placed responsibility for this Secretariat with the United Kingdom.

In addition, the Committee took note of information given by the Representative of United Kingdom, concerning the reexamination of the work programme of SP 16.

d — The Committee took note of information given by the Representative of USSR concerning the reexamination of the work programme of SP 21.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 7

The Committee took note of the report on the activities of the BIML during the period September 1987 - October 1988.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 8

The Committee elected :

1st Vice-President : Dr A.I. MEKHANNIKOV, USSR

2nd Vice-President : Dr S.E. CHAPPELL, USA.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 9

The Committee examined the decisions of the Eighth Conference in view of their implementation.

CIML 1988 — ITEM 11

The Committee decided to hold its 24th meeting in Paris during the last week of September 1989 in connection with a commemoration of the Bicentenary of the creation of the Metric System organized by the French government and a meeting of the International Committee of Weights and Measures.